

New State National Bank Holds Tree Planting Ceremony



"TREEBREAKING"—Taking part in ceremonies today at the new State National Bank Plaza were, from the left, Charles E. Black, owner of Black's Nursery; Mrs. Malcolm Welch, founder of the Beautify El Paso Assn.; Mrs. Ira Brawley, president of the El Paso Council of Garden Clubs; and, William M. Updike, vice president of the marketing division of State National Bank.

A "treebreaking" was celebrated by the State National Bank today at its soon-to-open 22-story tower in downtown El Paso.

The occasion, attended by beautification and bank officials, marked the first planting of trees in the Downtown area other than in San Jacinto and Pioneer Plazas, in many years.

THE LANDSCAPING around the bank's plaza includes 13 10 to 12 foot live oak trees, a long row of Dwarf Yaupon Holly plants, and the accenting of entrances at three sides of the tower with Golden Euonymus.

"You have painted a picture that everyone will enjoy," said Mrs. Malcolm Welch, founder of the Beautify El Paso Assn., to William M. Updike, State National vice president in charge of the marketing division, who introduced guests.

The trees each weigh 1,000 pounds and were lifted into place 30 feet apart by a 40-foot crane. There are nine trees on the widened Kansas street side, and two each on both the Mills and Texas avenues sides.

THE LANDSCAPING, done by Black's Nursery, was

designed to co-ordinate the tall structural elements in the tower, according to James G. Lewis, registered landscape architect, who directed the work for Black's.

Each of the trees was anchored in a 36-inch ball of special earth calculated to keep the trees healthy as they grow to a height of 20 feet on the site, where the Rio Grande once rolled 10 million years ago.

Other members of the Beautify El Paso Assn. present were Andrew H. Cohen, president, Mrs. George Kistenmacher, vice president, and Mrs. John Jagoe and Mrs. Cramer Williams, co-chairmen of the association's Downtown Clean-Up Committee.

OFFICIALS OF the El Paso Council of Garden Clubs present were Mrs. Ira Braley, president, Mrs. Orville L. Miller, past president, and Mrs. Fred K. Huber and Mrs. Sidney W. Howard, chairmen of the last garden club show. There were also bank and building officers present.

Participants were presented with the famed engrossments produced by the late J. R. Rosen entitled 'America, the Beautiful.'